12. Certainly, if you wait long enough, what you do to one particle can, in principle, affect the other: one particle could send out a signal alerting the other that it had been subjected to a measurement, and this signal could affect the receiving particle. However, as no signal can travel faster than the speed of light, this kind of influence is not instantaneous. The key point in the present discussion is that at the very moment that we measure the spin of one particle about a chosen axis we learn the spin of the other particle about that axis. And so, any kind of "standard" communication between the particles—luminal or subluminal communication—is not relevant.

13. In this and the next section, the distillation of Bell's discovery which I am using is a "dramatization" inspired by David Mermin's wonderful papers: "Quantum Mysteries for Anyone," *Journal of Philosophy* 78, (1981), pp. 397–408; "Can You Help Your Team Tonight by Watching on TV?," in *Philosophical Consequences of Quantum Theory: Reflectionson Bell's Theorem,* James T. Cushing and Ernan McMullin, eds. (University of Notre Dame Press, 1989); "Spooky Action at a Distance: Mysteries of the Quantum Theory," in *The Great Ideas Today* (Encyclopaedia Britannica, Inc., 1988), which are all collected in N. David Mermin, *Boojums All the Way Through* (Cambridge, Eng.: Cambridge University Press, 1990). For anyone interested in pursuing these ideas in a more technical manner, there is no better place to start than with Bell's own papers, many of which are collected in J. S. Bell, Speakable and Unspeakable in Quantum Mechanics (Cambridge, Eng.: Cambridge University Press, 1997).

14. While the locality assumption is critical to the argument of Einstein, Podolsky, and Rosen, researchers have tried to find fault with other elements of their reasoning in an attempt to avoid the conclusion that the universe admits nonlocal features. For example, it is sometimes claimed that all the data require is that we give up so-called realism—the idea that objects possess the properties they are measured to have independent of the measurement process. In this context, though, such a claim misses the point. If the EPR reasoning had been confirmed by experiment, there would be nothing mysterious about the long-range correlations of quantum mechanics; they'd be no more surprising than classical long-range correlations, such as the way finding your left-handed glove over here ensures that its partner over there is a right-